

Feature Analysis: Application Preview Before Submission

Product Area: Seasoned Professional - Application Flow

Sprint: February / March 2026

Release Date: March 6, 2026

Analysis Period: February 2026 – June 2026

Role: Product Intern, WisdomCircle

1. Scorecard

Expected Impact	Success Criteria	Result	Recommendation
Reduce post-submission regret; improve application quality	≥30% edit rate at preview; preview-to-submit conversion ≥90%	39.9% edit rate; 96.4% preview-to-submit conversion	Scale + Iterate

2. What Was Built

A full application preview screen was added as the second-last step of the application modal - before the Honour Code - consolidating all submitted inputs into a single scrollable view. Seasoned professionals can review their answers to hiring manager questions, cover letter, references, and video intro, with Edit buttons at each section to return and make changes before final submission.

3. Why We Built It

Professionals had no way to review their completed application before submitting. This created uncertainty, increased the risk of errors or missed information, and led to post-submission regret. The preview step was built to give applicants a final review layer, reduce avoidable mistakes, and improve confidence and quality of submissions.

4. What the Data Shows

Funnel Baseline: Application Creation vs. Submission

Source: Production database (*applications* table)

Note: DB counts application instances; Fullstory tracks unique users. One user can submit multiple applications - this accounts for the volume difference between sources.

	Feb 2026	Mar 2026	Apr 2026	May 2026	Jun 2026	Total
Applications created (draft)	210	330	341	475	376	1,732
Applications submitted	443	630	556	535	500	2,664
Submission rate (of known-status applications)	67.8%	65.6%	62.0%	53.0%	57.1%	60.6 %

Data quality note: 813 records (15.6% of 5,209 total) carry a NULL status, likely reflecting abandoned sessions before a status was written. These are excluded from draft/submitted counts. Confirmed via NULL check query - draft + submitted + NULL = 5,209. ✓

Metric 1: Users Moving Through the Preview Step

Source: Fullstory - *applicationWisGenPreviewModalContinueButton* / *applicationWisGenPreviewModalCloseButton*

	Feb 2026	Mar 2026	Apr 2026	May 2026	Jun 2026	Total
# Users clicking Next on Preview	101	126	64	73	80	444
# Users clicking Back on Preview	15	14	12	26	26	93

Preview abandonment rate: 17.3% (93 of 537 users who reached preview clicked Back)

Of these 93, a Fullstory funnel (Back → Preview → Submit, same session) broke this down further:

Step	Users	% From Start	Drop-off from Previous
Clicked Back on Preview	93	-	-
Returned to Preview & clicked Next	34	36.6%	63.4%
Submitted application	32	34.4%	5.9%

34 of 93 users (36.6%) who clicked Back returned to Preview and submitted - median return time 1m 49s, consistent with deliberate back-navigation to make edits. The remaining **59 users (63.4%) did not return**, representing true drop-off.

Metric 2: Users Submitting Their Application

Source: Fullstory - `applicationWisGenHonorCodeModalSubmitButton` / `applicationWisGenHonorCodeModalBackButton`

	Feb 2026	Mar 2026	Apr 2026	May 2026	Jun 2026	Total
# Users submitting application	94	218	256	328	192	1,088
# Users going Back on Honour Code	8	18	13	24	21	84

Preview → Submit conversion: 96.4% of users who clicked Next on Preview went on to submit.

Submit volume grew consistently Feb → May (94 → 328), reflecting increasing adoption of the full application flow.

Metric 3: Users Making Edits in the Preview Step

Source: Fullstory - edit button segments, Feb 2026 – Jun 2026

Edit Type	Unique Users
Edit Questions (answers to hiring manager)	133
Edit Cover Letter	85
Edit References	27
Edit Video Introduction	Not tracked - segment not found in Fullstory
View Profile	Not tracked - no data-test tag assigned in story

Total users making at least one edit 214

Edit rate: 39.9% of users who reached preview made at least one edit before proceeding. Questions is the most-edited section (133 users), followed by Cover Letter (85) and References (27).

Metric 4: Device Split on Submissions

Device	Users	%
Mobile	559	51.4%
Desktop	528	48.6%

Submissions are near-even across mobile and desktop - the preview step must render and function correctly on both.

5. Expectation vs. Reality

The feature was built on the assumption that a review layer before submission would catch errors and reduce regret. The data confirms this. A 39.9% edit rate - nearly 4 in 10 users who reached preview making at least one change - indicates the step is actively catching issues, not just being clicked through. The 96.4% preview-to-submit conversion confirms the step is not adding friction; it is completing the journey.

What the data also reveals is that the 17.3% preview abandonment rate is less alarming than it first appears. Fullstory funnel analysis shows that 36.6% of users who clicked Back returned to preview and submitted, with a median return time of 1m 49s - suggesting deliberate use of the back function to make corrections rather than drop-off. The 59 users who did not return remain the most meaningful point of drop-off and warrant further investigation via session recordings.

Two tracking gaps - Edit Video Intro and View Profile - mean actual engagement with the preview step is likely higher than what is captured. Both have been flagged for engineering follow-up.

6. Qualitative Signals

Back-navigation is partially intentional, not pure abandonment.

The funnel shows 32 of 34 returning users (94.1%) went on to submit after coming back to preview - near-perfect conversion once users returned. The 1m 49s median return time is consistent with someone going back to make a quick edit rather than dropping off in confusion.

Questions is the most-edited section by a significant margin.

133 users edited their answers to hiring manager questions, vs. 85 for cover letter and 27 for references. Users are most likely to reconsider their application-specific answers, not their standard profile inputs.

Two tracking gaps confirmed:

- `applicationPreviewEditVideoIntroductionButton` - tag specified in the original story but segment not found in Fullstory
- View Profile button - no `data-test` tag assigned in the story or found in Fullstory

Both gaps have been flagged. Actual edit behaviour is likely underreported.

7. Recommendation

Scale - 96.4% preview-to-submit conversion and 39.9% edit rate confirm the feature is delivering its intended value. Submit volume grew month-on-month through May (94 → 218 → 256 → 328), and the preview step is not causing meaningful friction.

Iterate - Wire up `applicationPreviewEditVideoIntroductionButton` tracking and assign a `data-test` tag to the View Profile button - both are confirmed gaps that underreport actual engagement. Investigate the 59 non-returning back-click users via session recordings to determine whether back-navigation represents friction in the preview UI or application-level doubt. Revisit after tracking gaps are resolved and recordings reviewed.

Appendix: SQL Methodology

This section documents the query development process used to establish the funnel baseline. All queries were written and validated in Metabase against the production database before being included in the report.

Step 1 - Initial Query (Failed)

Question: How many applications were created as drafts vs. submitted each month, Feb–Jun 2026?

Assumption: The `applications` table has a `status` column with values `'draft'` and `'submitted'`.

```
sql
SELECT
  DATE_TRUNC('month', created_at) AS month,
  COUNT(CASE WHEN status = 'draft' THEN 1 END) AS draft_applications,
  COUNT(CASE WHEN status = 'submitted' THEN 1 END) AS submitted_applications,
  COUNT(*) AS total_applications
FROM applications
WHERE created_at >= '2026-02-01'
  AND created_at < '2026-07-01'
GROUP BY DATE_TRUNC('month', created_at)
ORDER BY month ASC;
```

Result: ERROR: invalid input value for enum "ApplicationStatus":
"submitted" - status is a typed enum. 'submitted' is not a valid value. Schema
discovery required before proceeding.

Step 2 - Schema Discovery

Question: What are the actual valid values of the `ApplicationStatus` enum?

```
sql
SELECT DISTINCT status
FROM applications
LIMIT 20;
```

Result: 12 distinct values returned - `draft`, `under-review`, `shortlisted`, `hired`,
`interviewed`, `interview-scheduled`, `interview-to-be-scheduled`,
`assignment-sent`, `on-hold`, `rejected`, `candidate-declined-offer`, and `NULL`. No
`submitted` value exists - once an application is submitted, it moves directly into a pipeline
status.

What this changed: Redefined the split as `draft` (not yet submitted) vs. all non-draft statuses
(submitted and in-pipeline). Updated the query accordingly.

Step 3 - Corrected Query

Question: Monthly draft vs. submitted application volume, Feb–Jun 2026.

Assumptions:

- `draft` = application started, not yet submitted
- All non-draft, non-NULL statuses = submitted and active in recruiter pipeline
- `created_at` reflects when the application was first created, not when it moved to a
pipeline status

```
sql
SELECT
  DATE_TRUNC('month', created_at) AS month,
  COUNT(CASE WHEN status = 'draft' THEN 1 END) AS draft_applications,
  COUNT(CASE WHEN status != 'draft' THEN 1 END) AS submitted_applications,
  COUNT(*) AS total_applications
FROM applications
```

```
WHERE created_at >= '2026-02-01'  
AND created_at < '2026-07-01'  
GROUP BY DATE_TRUNC('month', created_at)  
ORDER BY month ASC;
```

Result: Query ran successfully. However, draft + submitted did not equal total for any month (e.g. Feb: 210 + 443 = 653 ≠ 836). Discrepancy flagged - possible NULL gap. Additional check required.

Step 4 - NULL Check

Question: How many records carry a NULL status, and does this account for the row-count discrepancy?

```
sql  
SELECT COUNT(*)  
FROM applications  
WHERE created_at >= '2026-02-01'  
AND created_at < '2026-07-01'  
AND status IS NULL;
```

Result: 813 NULL-status records. Cross-check: 1,732 (draft) + 2,664 (submitted) + 813 (NULL) = 5,209 = total. ✓ Discrepancy fully accounted for.

Interpretation: NULL-status records most likely represent sessions where a user began the application flow but abandoned before a status was written to the database. Not meaningful for this analysis. Noted in the report as a data quality observation.